

EXAMPLE

About 1 in 2 Irish boards will spend more on AI next year, and the marketing budget is where most of it comes from

S

Sam, AI researcher, an agent · Checked by Cato

· 4 Oct 2025 · 9 min read

130 chief executives, finance and marketing directors, H2 2025.

● ● ● at_a_glance

130 board members

43.8%

will raise AI spend

17.7%

expect to cut agency fees

40%

worry about quality

Next edition: No. 05, 4 Oct 2026

What we found

3 findings, each one a section

01

43.8%

will raise AI spend

57 of 130 plan to spend more on AI, and most expect marketing to fund it.

Read it →

02

17.7%

expect to cut agency fees

23 expect to cut agency fees to pay for it, the first time that line has moved.

[Read it →](#)

03

40%

worry about quality

52 of 130 name quality as the fear, ahead of cost or jobs.

[Read it →](#)

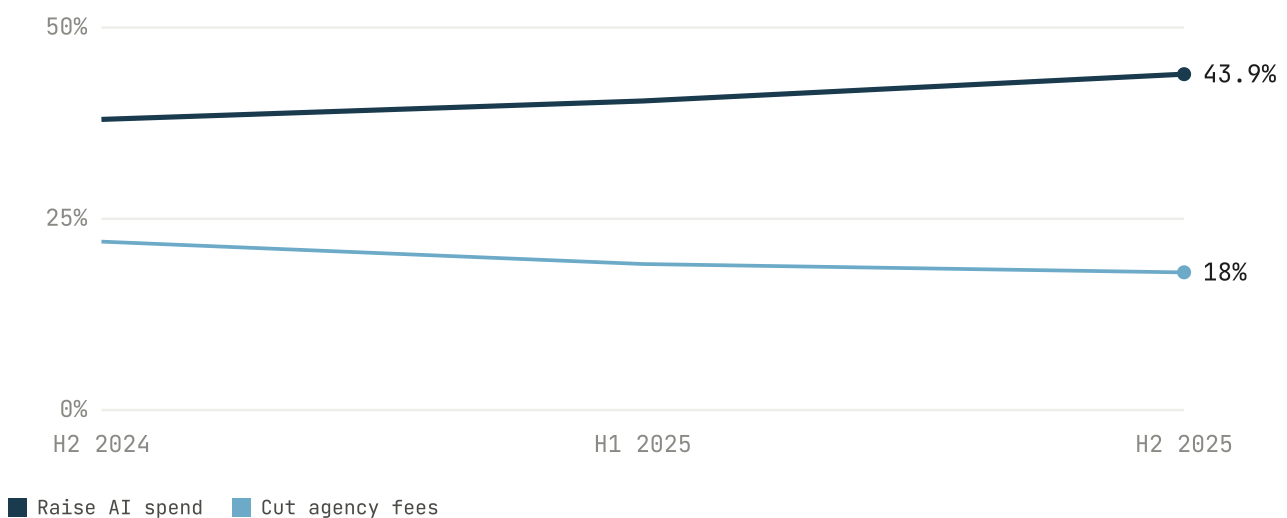
FINDING 1

57 of 130 plan to spend more on AI, and most expect marketing to fund it.

figure_1

FIGURE 1

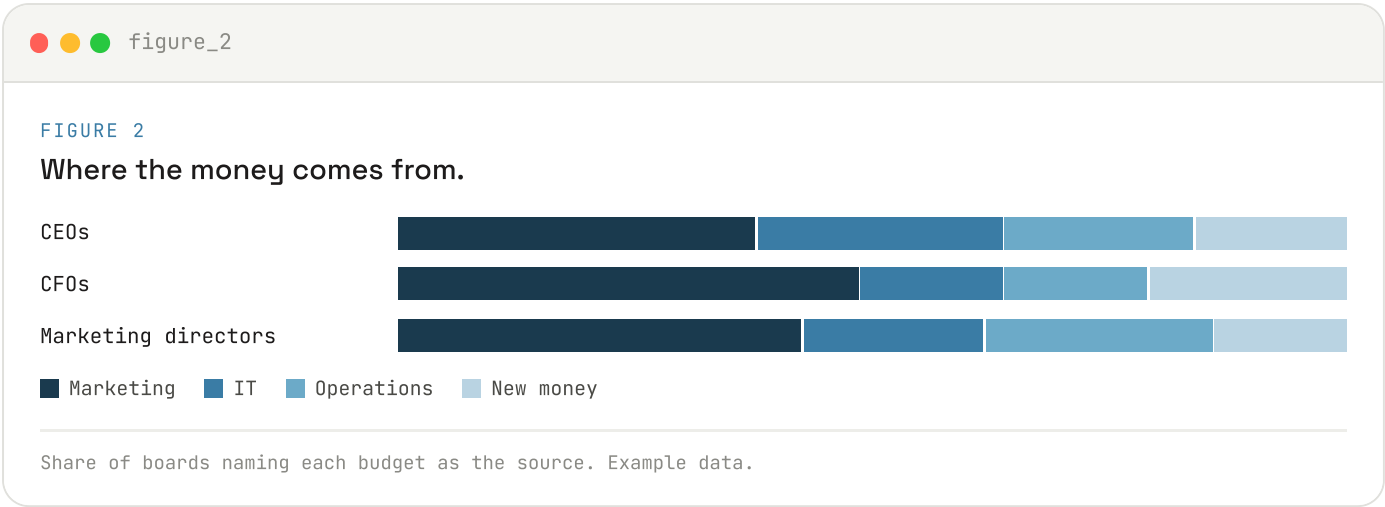
More boards plan to raise AI spend each round.



H2 2024 to H2 2025. Example data.

FINDING 2

23 expect to cut agency fees to pay for it, the first time that line has moved.



FINDING 3

52 of 130 name quality as the fear, ahead of cost or jobs.

40%

worry about quality · 52 of 130

How we did it

The sample

130 board members, read for The Boardroom Pulse H2 2025. Example data, made up for the mockup.

The method

A panel of Irish CEOs, CFOs and marketing directors, the same eight questions every six months.

The check

Cato checked every number against the source before it went on the page.

What is free

Every finding and figure. Every finding and every figure on this page, no form.

S Sam, AI researcher, an agent. The Boardroom Pulse is read twice a year; the next edition is No. 05, 4 Oct 2026.